

Word family: **empty / emptiness**

Base word: empty

Past tense: emptied

Past participle: emptied

Related forms: emptiness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞) / noun-related form (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of **empty** promises.”

Meaning in this passage

Meaning: A promise that sounds good but has little real intention, substance, or likelihood of being fulfilled.

繁體中文: **表面上作出承諾, 但缺乏真實行動、誠意或實際內容的**

中文翻譯:

「它並不花巧浮誇, 也不咄咄逼人, 更沒有充斥**缺乏實際內容和誠意的空洞承諾**。」

empty promise = 聽起來像承諾, 但缺乏實際內容、行動或兌現誠意的承諾

1. **empty = container/storage space (容器／儲存空間) containing nothing — 裡面沒有任何東西的; 空的**

Meaning: Having nothing inside.

Practice 1

> “The bottle is **empty**.”

「瓶子裡**完全沒有東西／液體了**。」

Practice 2

> “I opened the box, but it was **empty**.”

「我打開盒子, 但裡面**甚麼也沒有**。」

empty = 容器內沒有任何東西的

2. **empty = place/room/building (地方／房間／建築物) with nobody there — 沒有人在裡面的; 空無一人的**

Meaning: Having no people present.

Practice 3

> “The office was **empty** when I arrived.”

「我到達時，辦公室裡**一個人也沒有**。」

Practice 4

> “The streets were almost **empty** late at night.”

「深夜時，街上**幾乎沒有人**。」

empty place = 沒有人在其中、顯得空無一人的地方

This differs from #1:

* **empty bottle** → 沒有內容物

* **empty office** → 沒有人

3. **empty = seat/space/position (座位／位置／空間) not occupied or being used — 沒有人／物佔用的; 空著的**

Meaning: Available because nobody or nothing is occupying it.

Practice 5

> “Is this seat **empty**?”

「這個座位**沒有人坐／是空著的**嗎？」

Practice 6

> “There was one **empty** parking space near the entrance.”

「入口附近有一個**沒有人使用的空置車位**。」

empty seat/space = 沒有人或物正在佔用、可以使用的

This is related to #2, but the focus is ****availability of a particular position****, not whether an entire place has people in it.

4. ****empty = words/promise/threat(說話／承諾／威脅)having no real substance or intention behind them — 空洞的; 缺乏實質內容或誠意的****

This is the meaning in your original sentence.

****Meaning:**** Sounding meaningful or impressive, but lacking real intention, evidence, action, or substance.

Practice 7 — Original

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of ****empty**** promises.”

「它並不花巧浮誇，也不咄咄逼人，更沒有充斥****缺乏實際內容和誠意的空洞承諾****。」

Practice 8

> “Customers are tired of ****empty**** promises from companies.”

「顧客已厭倦公司那些****沒有實際行動支持、難以兌現的承諾****。」

Practice 9

> “His apology sounded ****empty****.”

「他的道歉聽起來****缺乏真誠和實際誠意****。」

****empty words/promises = 表面有內容，但實際缺乏誠意、行動或實質意義的****

5. ****empty = feeling/life/experience(感受／生活／經歷)lacking meaning, emotion, or fulfilment — 空虛的; 缺乏意義或滿足感的****

****Meaning:**** Feeling that something important, meaningful, or emotionally satisfying is missing.

Practice 10

> “After the project ended, she felt strangely ****empty****.”

「專案結束後，她感到一種****內心缺乏滿足感和意義的空虛****。」

Practice 11

> “Success felt **empty** without anyone to share it with.”

「如果沒有人可以分享, 成功也讓人感到**缺乏真正滿足感和意義**。」

empty = 內心或生活缺乏意義、情感或滿足感的

6. **empty** = stomach (胃) containing no food — 胃裡沒有食物的; 空腹的

Meaning: Having little or no food in the stomach.

Practice 12

> “I went to work on an **empty** stomach.”

「我**空著肚子／沒有吃東西**就去上班了。」

Practice 13

> “You shouldn’t take this medicine on an **empty** stomach.”

「你不應該在**空腹、胃裡沒有食物**的情況下**服用這種藥**。」

empty stomach = 胃裡沒有食物、處於空腹狀態

7. **empty** = expression/look/eyes (表情／眼神) showing no emotion or reaction — 沒有流露情感的; 茫然的

Meaning: Showing little or no emotion, thought, or response.

Practice 14

> “He stared at me with an **empty** expression.”

「他用一副**沒有流露任何情緒、顯得茫然的表情**看著我。」

Practice 15

> “There was an **empty** look in her eyes.”

「她的眼神**沒有明顯情緒或反應, 顯得很空洞**。」

****empty expression/look = 缺乏情緒或反應、顯得茫然空洞的****

8. ****empty = sound/room/acoustic quality (聲音／空間感) hollow and lacking richness — 空洞的; 缺乏厚度或共鳴的****

****Meaning:** Sounding hollow, thin, or lacking richness.**

Practice 16

> “The room made his voice sound ****empty****.”

「那個房間令他的聲音聽起來****空洞、缺乏厚度和共鳴****。」

Practice 17

> “The recording sounded ****empty**** without the bass.”

「沒有低音後，錄音聽起來****很單薄空洞、缺乏飽滿感****。」

****empty sound = 聲音缺乏厚度、層次或共鳴感的****

9. ****empty + container/place (容器／地方) — 把裡面的東西全部清走／倒出****

Here, ****empty**** is a ****verb****.

****Meaning:** To remove everything from a container or place.**

Practice 18

> “Please ****empty**** the rubbish bin.”

「請把垃圾桶裡的東西****全部清空****。」

Practice 19

> “She ****emptied**** the contents of her bag onto the table.”

「她把袋子裡的東西****全部倒到桌上****。」

****empty something = 把某容器或地方裡面的東西全部移走，使其變空****

10. ****place/container empties** (地方／容器) — 裡面的人或物逐漸離開, 使其變空******

****Meaning:**** To become empty because people or contents leave.

Practice 20

> “The station quickly ****emptied**** after the last train.”

「尾班車開走後, 車站裡的人很快便****陸續離開, 變得空無一人****。」

Practice 21

> “The bottle ****emptied**** slowly as the water leaked out.”

「隨著水慢慢漏出, 瓶子逐漸****變空****。」

****empty = 因人或內容物離開而逐漸變成空的狀態****

11. ****emptiness = absence of people/things/content** (缺少人／物／內容的狀態) — 空無; 空蕩******

****Meaning:**** The state of containing nothing or having nobody present.

Practice 22

> “The ****emptiness**** of the building felt unusual.”

「大樓****空無一人、十分空蕩的狀態****令人覺得不尋常。」

Practice 23

> “The room’s ****emptiness**** made it feel larger.”

「房間因為****幾乎沒有物件、十分空曠****, 所以顯得更大。」

****emptiness = 缺乏人、物或內容而形成的空蕩狀態****

12. ****emptiness = emotional lack of meaning/fulfilment** (心理上缺乏意義／滿足) — 空虛感******

****Meaning:**** A feeling of emotional absence, lack of purpose, or lack of fulfilment.

Practice 24

> “He felt a deep sense of ****emptiness**** after retiring.”

「退休後，他感到很深的****內心空虛和失去生活重心的感覺****。」

Practice 25

> “Material success did not remove her sense of ****emptiness****.”

「物質上的成功並沒有消除她那種****缺乏內在滿足和意義的空虛感****。」

****emotional emptiness = 內心缺乏意義、情感連結或滿足感的狀態****

Important distinction: ****empty vs vacant****

They overlap, but their focus can differ.

****empty****

= nothing/nobody is there

> “an ****empty**** room”

> = 房間裡沒有人／東西很少

****vacant****

= officially available for someone to occupy or use

> “a ****vacant**** apartment”

> = ****目前沒有住戶、可供入住的**單位**

> “a ****vacant**** position”

> = ****目前沒有人擔任、等待招聘的**職位**

So ****vacant**** often emphasizes ****availability****, while ****empty**** emphasizes ****absence****.

Important distinction: **empty** vs **blank**

empty

= nothing is inside / no meaningful content

> “an **empty** box”

> = 空盒

blank

= nothing is written, printed, or shown on a surface

> “a **blank** page”

> = 空白頁

A page can be **blank**, but we normally would not describe it as an **empty page** when we simply mean nothing is written on it.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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empty container	容器內沒有任何內容物的
empty room/place	裡面沒有人、顯得空無一人的
empty seat/space	沒有人或物佔用、目前可以使用的
empty promise/words	表面有內容, 但實際缺乏誠意、行動或實質意義的
feel empty	內心缺乏意義、情感或滿足感的
empty stomach	胃裡沒有食物、處於空腹狀態的
empty expression/look	沒有流露明顯情緒或反應、顯得茫然的
empty sound	聲音缺乏厚度、層次或共鳴的
empty + container/place	把裡面的東西全部清走或倒出
place/container empties	因人或內容物離開而逐漸變空
emptiness — physical	缺乏人、物或內容所形成的空蕩狀態
emptiness — emotional	內心缺乏意義、連結或滿足感的空虛狀態

For your original sentence

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of **empty promises**.”

The exact meaning is:

****empty = 表面上像有內容, 但實際缺乏真實誠意、實際行動或實質價值的****

So:

****empty promises = 聽起來很好, 但缺乏實際行動或兌現誠意的空洞承諾****